

Data Appendix

Business Concentration around the World: 1900–2020

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DA1 Data Description by Country

This appendix describes the data sources for each country in detail.

DA1.1 Australia

Table [DA1](#) lists the sources that we use for Australia.

Table DA1 – Australia: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by net income	1940–1957	Australian Taxation Office (various years) <i>Report of the Commissioner of Taxation</i> .
	1958–2020	Australian Taxation Office (various years) <i>Taxation Statistics</i> .
CR20 by sales (manufacturing)	1968–1987	Australian Bureau of Statistics (1987) <i>Manufacturing Industry Concentration Statistics</i> .
	1990–1991	Australian Bureau of Statistics (1994) <i>Manufacturing Industry</i> .
Tabulations by employment (manufacturing)	1968–1986	Australian Bureau of Statistics (various years) <i>Enterprise Statistics</i> .
	2004–2005	Australian Bureau of Statistics (various years) <i>Australian Industry</i> .

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Australian data.

DA1.1.1 By Net Income

Sources We are able to find tabulations by size of taxable income for corporations starting in 1940 from *Taxation Statistics* published by the Australian Taxation Office. We download PDFs from the National Library of Australia until income year 1993–1994 ([Australian Taxation Office, 1944-1961, 1962-1995](#)) and transcribe the data; we download data in Excel spreadsheets from [data.gov.au](#) afterwards ([Australian Taxation Office, 2013-2023](#)). The tabulations are based on information from the corporate income tax.

Scope The data cover corporations with positive taxable income. Each unit is a company defined under the Assessment Act. After 2002, wholly-owned businesses can consolidate under a single entity. Up to 1949, we use taxable companies with positive taxable income because the data only have taxable companies. After 1950, we have both taxable and non-taxable companies with positive taxable income, but the number of non-taxable companies with positive taxable income is negligible, and we check that the results are similar if we restrict to taxable companies. The tabulations by size include both resident and nonresident companies until 1998, and only resident companies from 1999. In years when there are breakdowns of resident and nonresident companies, we check that the results are similar if we restrict to resident companies only.

Variable definition Taxable income is defined as the amount remaining after deducting from assessable income all deductions allowed. Such deductions include all normal business expenses, certain special deductions for expenditure of a capital nature and certain non-business deductions ([Australian Taxation Office, 1962-1995](#)). For resident companies, domestic income and certain foreign income are included; for nonresident companies, only income derived from Australia is included.

Corporate share Since the size tabulations for Australia are restricted to corporations, we need to estimate the share of corporations relative to all businesses, which is especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1. We use the estimated corporate share in gross value added of private businesses.

Specifically, we have data on gross operating surplus of corporations and gross mixed income of non-corporations since 1960 from the Australian Bureau of Statistics ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2023](#)) and before then from [Butlin \(1985\)](#). To estimate gross value added of corporations and non-corporations, we also need information about the compensation of employees of corporations and non-corporations. The Australian national accounts provide total compensation of employees (including wages and employers' social contributions) for the public and private sector since 1983. The national accounts do not have a breakdown for compensation of employees by corporations versus non-corporations. For most years since 1981, we can obtain salaries and wage expenses by corporations and non-corporations from *Taxation Statistics* ([Australian Taxation Office, 1962-1995, 2013-2023](#)).

To cover the sample period of our Australian firm size distribution data since 1940, we estimate the corporate share over this period by assuming that the ratio of compensation of employees to value added among corporations is the same as that in the overall private businesses. In this case, the corporate value added share would be the same as gross operating surplus of corporations relative to gross operating surplus of corporations plus gross mixed income of non-corporations. This estimate is shown by the solid line with diamonds in Figure DA1. For 1983 onward, we can directly compute corporations' share in value added: we take compensation of employees among the private sector from the national accounts, and allocate to corporations and non-corporations using their shares in salary and wage expenses according to *Taxation Statistics* data; then we obtain the corporation value added share as corporate compensation of employees plus corporate gross operating surplus, divided by private

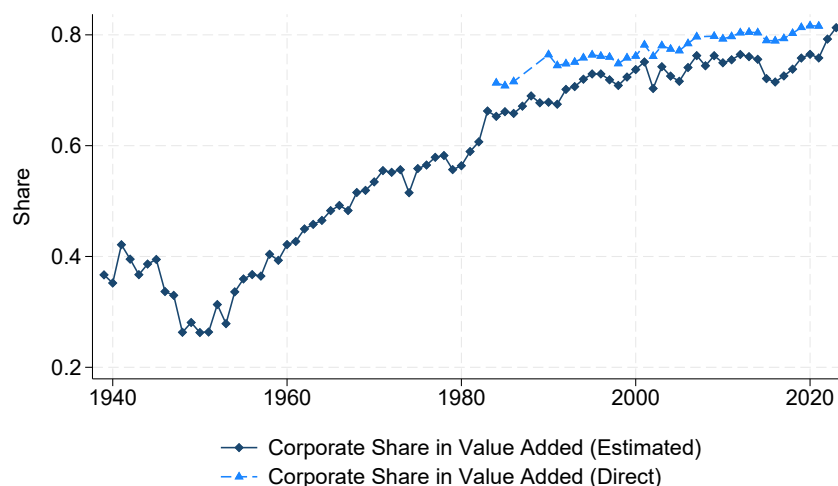


Figure DA1. Australia: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share in private business value added for Australia. The solid line with diamonds uses the ratio of corporate gross operating surplus to corporate gross operating surplus plus non-corporate mixed income. The data come from the Australian Bureau of Statistics ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2023](#)) after 1960 and [Butlin \(1985\)](#) before then. This estimate assumes that the ratio of compensation of employees to value added among corporations is the same as that among private businesses overall. The dashed line with triangles uses the ratio of corporate gross operating surplus plus corporate compensation of employees to corporate gross operating surplus plus non-corporate mixed income plus private business compensation of employees. Corporate compensation of employees is obtained by multiplying private business compensation of employees by the ratio of corporate to corporate and non-corporate salary and wage expenses in *Taxation Statistics*.

business compensation of employees plus corporate gross operating surplus plus non-corporate mixed income. This series is shown by the dashed line with triangles in Figure DA1. This cross check suggests that our baseline estimate is sensible.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ net income share = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of corporations in a given year. Restricted to those with positive net income.
- Top $x\%$ net income share among top $y\%$ = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of top $y\%$ corporations in a given year. Restricted to those with positive net income.
- Top N net income share = Net income of top N corporations by net income in a given year/Estimated net income of corporations and non-corporations in a given year (starting with net income of corporations and dividing by estimated corporate share as discussed above). Restricted to those with positive net income.

DA1.1.2 CR20 by Sales

Sources We are able to find CR20 for two-digit manufacturing industries reported consistently from 1968 to 1991, from publications by the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) based on manufacturing censuses. We obtain physical books from the ZBW Library in Kiel for data up to 1987 ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1990](#)), and download PDFs from the ABS website for 1990 to 1991 ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1994](#)); we then transcribe the data. Data from census publications also exist for 1992 and 1993, but are not consistent due to the industry classification change from ASIC to ANZSIC.

Scope The data cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is an enterprise group, which includes all operations in Australia of a group of legal entities (enterprises) under common ownership or control following the Companies Acts. Enterprise groups in the concentration statistics are formed by combining establishments within the enterprise group with the same industry classification. Single establishment enterprises with fewer than four persons employed are excluded from 1977 to 1987; this difference is not expected to have any major impact as these small businesses contribute only marginally to statistical aggregates ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1994](#)).

Variable definition Sales are defined as sales of goods.

DA1.1.3 By Employment

Sources We are able to find Australian data on firm size by employment in manufacturing from 1968 to 2005 from two sources. First, we have tabulations for 1968 to 1986 from *Enterprise Statistics* by the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS), which was initially published for the 1968–1969 integrated economic census, then continuously every year from 1977–1978 to 1986–1987, and apparently discontinued after that. We obtain physical books from Cornell University Library (1980, 1981, 1983, 1984), Stanford University Library (1974), University of Chicago Library (1977 and 1978), and University of London Library (1968, 1979, 1982, 1985, and 1986) ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1968-1982, 1983-1987](#)); we then transcribe the data. Second, we are able to find tabulations for 2004–2005 and 2005–2006 from *Australian Industry* published by the ABS. We download data in Excel spreadsheets from [abs.gov.au](#) ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2007](#)). These tabulations are coarser, and report the number and employment of small (zero to 19 employees), medium (20 to 199 employees), and large (over 200 employees) businesses. Since the large business bin contains about 630 manufacturing firms, we can estimate the top 500 share reasonably well. The estimates presented are derived using a combination of directly collected data from the annual Economic Activity Survey (EAS) conducted by the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS), and business income tax (BIT) data provided by businesses to the Australian Taxation Office (ATO).

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is an enterprise, which covers all the operations in Australia of

Table DA2 – Austria: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by sales	1954–1957	Österreichisches Statistisches Zentralamt (various years) <i>Steuerstatistiken</i> .
	1958–1969	Österreichisches Statistisches Zentralamt (various years) <i>Statistisches Handbuch für die Republik Österreich</i> . Used to fill in gaps.
	1970–2020	Österreichisches Statistisches Zentralamt (various years) <i>Umsatzsteuerstatistik</i> . Renamed to Statistik Österreich (various years) <i>Statistik der Umsatzsteuer</i> in 1998.

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Austrian data.

a single operating legal entity. Single establishment enterprises with fewer than four persons employed are excluded from 1977 to 1987 ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1968-1982, 1983-1987](#)). This exclusion should not affect top firms in the numerator. For the denominator, we fill in the total number and employment of single establishment enterprises with fewer than four persons employed from additional publications ([Commonwealth Bureau of Census and Statistics, 1973](#); [Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1980a,b, 1981, 1985, 1986](#)).

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is generally a business in the ABS Business Register; for large and complex businesses, the ABS may instead use a type-of-activity unit combining entities within an enterprise group by industry activity.

Variable definition For both sources, employment includes employees and working proprietors on payroll, including part-time employees.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ employment share = Employment of top $x\%$ enterprises in a given year/Total employment of enterprises in a given year.
- Top N employment share = Employment of top N enterprises in a given year/Total employment of enterprises in a given year.

DA1.2 Austria

Table [DA2](#) lists the sources that we use for Austria.

Sources We are able to find tabulations by size of sales for all types of firms since 1954, in tax-related statistical publications by the Austrian statistical office. We obtain physical books from the German National Library before 2012 ([Österreichisches Statistisches Zentralamt, 1958, 1961-1973, 1974-1999](#); [Statistik Österreich, 2000](#); [Statistik Austria, 2001-2014](#)), and download PDFs from the the ZBW digital

archive afterwards ([Statistik Austria, 2015-2023a](#)); we then transcribe the data. The tabulations are based on information from the sales tax (first introduced in 1923) and value added tax (VAT) after the conversion to VAT in 1972. The Austrian statistical office published tabulations by total sales for the first time in 1954.³⁷

Scope The data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation in the tabulations is a VAT-taxpayer. If multiple businesses are financially, economically, and organizationally integrated, they are required to file a joint VAT return. If an individual operates multiple businesses, the total revenue from all businesses is combined (and the threshold applies to this combined amount). The minimum sales threshold was 1,500 Schillings in 1954, 40,000 Schillings in 1973, 30,000 Euros in 2018, and 35,000 Euros in 2020 ([Österreichisches Statistisches Zentralamt, 1958, 1977](#); [Statistik Austria, 2021, 2023b](#)). Firms that want to claim a VAT refund on their inputs also file tax returns and are included in the tabulations even if they are below these size thresholds. We impose a minimum size threshold of 40,000 Schillings (until 1998) and 3,000 Euros (from 1999) for all tabulations. This excludes returns with zero or very small sales, and ensures that firm counts do not have major discontinuities due to changes in filing thresholds.

Variable definition The statistics tabulate firms based on total sales from the provision of all goods and services that a business carries out in Austria (including exports). Certain types of economic activities are exempt from VAT (most of banking and insurance services, healthcare, private education, cultural services, and the long-term leasing of real estate). Sales in these sectors are only captured by the tax statistics if firms are required to submit a return (for example, due to additional taxable activities) or if they voluntarily file a tax return.

Figure [DA2](#) shows the coverage of the dataset. The left panel shows log total sales from the tabulations. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales relative to GDP (solid line with circles) is around two, and relative to gross output (dashed line with diamonds) is around one in years when we can find gross output data. These comparisons show that our data have comprehensive and consistent coverage (gross output in national accounts—which is the counterpart of sales—is typically twice the level of GDP).

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share among top $y\%$ = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/Sales of top $y\%$ firms by sales in a given year.
- Top N sales share = Sales of top N firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.

³⁷The statistical office also publishes tabulations by size from the business tax and corporate tax. We focus on the sales tax system because it includes all types of firms, while the other taxes exclude sole proprietorships.

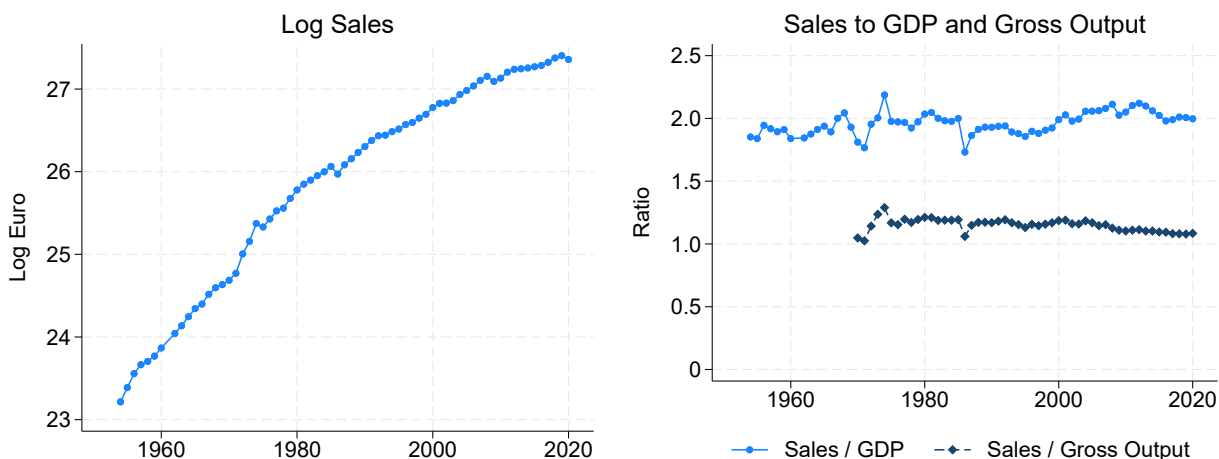


Figure DA2. Austria: Coverage of Sales in Tax Statistics

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated sales in our data. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales to GDP (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). GDP data come from [Statistisches Bundesamt \(1960-1972\)](#) and [OECD \(2014\)](#). Gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)). Before 1999, we convert the Austrian Schilling to Euro with a rate of 1 Euro = 13.7603 Schillings.

Table DA3 – Canada: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by net income	1944–1964	Department of National Revenue (various years) <i>Taxation Statistics</i> .
	1969–1987	Statistics Canada (various years) <i>Corporation Taxation Statistics</i> .

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Canadian data.

DA1.3 Canada

Table [DA3](#) lists the sources that we use for Canada.

Sources We have tabulations by size of taxable income for corporations between 1944 and 1964 from *Taxation Statistics* published by the Department of National Revenue, and between 1969 and 1987 from *Corporation Taxation Statistics* published by Statistics Canada. We obtain physical books from the University of Chicago Library ([Department of National Revenue, 1944-1964](#); [Statistics Canada, 1969-1987](#)), and transcribe the data. These tabulations are based on corporate income tax returns.

Scope The data cover corporations that file a T2 corporation income tax return, and we use corporations with positive income. During the *Taxation Statistics* years, the tabulations include all fully tabulated corporations, which exclude banks and insurance companies, co-operatives, personal corporations, and

companies with incomplete returns. During the *Corporation Taxation Statistics* years, the tabulations exclude credit unions, insurance carriers, non-profit organizations, trustee pension funds, and municipally owned corporations. For these years, we use the tabulations for total non-financial industries given the exclusion of banks in the earlier years. A nonresident corporation has to file a return if, at any time in the year, one of the following situations applies:³⁸ 1) it carried on business in Canada; 2) it had a taxable capital gain; 3) it disposed of taxable Canadian property, unless the disposition meets all the exemption criteria.

In some years, corporations below a certain threshold are excluded ([Department of National Revenue, 1944, 1948](#); [Statistics Canada, 1969, 1985-1986](#)).

- From 1944 to 1947, corporations with gross revenue less than \$1,000 were considered inactive companies and excluded (with the exception of mining or oil development companies that spend over \$1,000 on their property, and investment trusts with a balance sheet that shows cash or marketable securities having a value in excess of \$25,000).
- From 1948 to 1964, corporations with gross revenue less than \$2,000 were excluded (with the exception of mining or oil development companies that spend over \$2,000 on their property, and investment trusts with a balance sheet that shows cash or marketable securities having a value in excess of \$25,000).
- From 1969 to 1980, the publications did not explicitly mention size exclusion.
- From 1981 to 1984, corporations for which assets, equity, sales, profits before taxes, and taxable income were less than \$25,000 were not sampled, but estimates for them were included in the tabulations.
- From 1985 to 1987, corporations with assets less than \$50,000 and sales less than \$10,000 were considered inactive and excluded from both sampling and estimation.

Variable definition The tabulations use taxable income. For resident companies, income includes domestic and certain foreign income; for nonresident companies, only income derived from Canada is included.

Corporate share Since the size tabulations for Canada are restricted to corporations, we need to estimate the share of corporations relative to all businesses (especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1). We use the estimated corporate share in net value added of private businesses.

Specifically, we have data on corporate profits and net income of unincorporated businesses (farm and non-farm), for the entire sample period from Statistics Canada ([Statistics Canada, 1960-2011a](#)) and Historical Statistics of Canada ([Historical Statistics of Canada, 1926-1976](#)). The Canadian national accounts data on the net income of unincorporated businesses include imputed rent from owner-

³⁸See more information here: <https://www.canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/forms-publications/publications/t4012/t2-corporation-income-tax-guide-before-you-start.html>.

occupied housing, which we remove using additional data.³⁹ Like in the case of Australia, we do not have direct information about the compensation of employees by corporations versus non-corporations, except for wages, salaries, and employee benefits for the corporate sector since 1999 reported in the *Financial and Taxation Statistics for Enterprises* (Statistics Canada, 2002, 2006, 2011b, 2016). This dataset covers all incorporated enterprises within the domestic economy of Canada, but excludes enterprises classified to Management of Companies and Enterprises (NAICS 55); Religious Organizations (NAICS 8131); Political Organizations (NAICS 81394); Public Administration (NAICS 91); as well as Funds and other Financial Vehicles (NAICS 526).⁴⁰

To cover the sample period of our Canadian firm size distribution data, we estimate the corporate share over this period by assuming that the ratio of compensation of employees to value added among corporations is the same as that in the overall private businesses (similar to the Australian case). In this case, the corporate value added share would be the same as the ratio of corporate profits to corporate profits plus net income of unincorporated businesses (excluding imputed rents from owner-occupied housing). This estimate is shown by the solid line with diamonds in Figure DA3. For 1999 onward, we can directly compute corporations' share in value added as corporate wages, salaries and employee benefits (from *Financial and Taxation Statistics for Enterprises*) plus corporate profits, divided by wages, salaries and supplementary labor income from businesses and persons (from national accounts) plus corporate profits plus net income of unincorporated businesses (excluding imputed rents from owner-occupied housing). This series is shown by the dashed line with triangles in Figure DA3. The two lines are similar; the exclusion of NAICS 55 in corporate wages, salaries and employee benefits data could lead to a slight underestimate in the dashed line. Overall, this cross check suggests that our baseline estimate is sensible.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ net income share = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of corporations in a given year. Restricted to those with positive net income.
- Top $x\%$ net income share among top $y\%$ = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of top $y\%$ corporations by net income in a given year. Restricted to those with positive net income.
- Top N net income share = Net income of top N corporations by net income in a given year/Estimated

³⁹We use data on the net value added of owner-occupied housing from Piketty and Zucman (2014) available since 1960, and estimate it in earlier years using a closely related item "gross imputed rent" available from the Canadian national accounts since 1960 (Statistics Canada, 1976). Net value added of owner-occupied housing from Piketty and Zucman (2014) has a stable relationship with gross imputed rent for years with overlap, so we project the former onto the latter and then predict the former between 1947 and 1960.

⁴⁰The Canadian national accounts have a breakdown of "Wages, salaries and supplementary labour income" into from business, from persons, and from government. The business sector includes corporations as well as unincorporated business enterprises (the persons sector includes individuals as well as universities and other non-profit organizations) (Statistics Canada, 1975). Therefore, we cannot use this breakdown to directly obtain wages of the corporate sector.

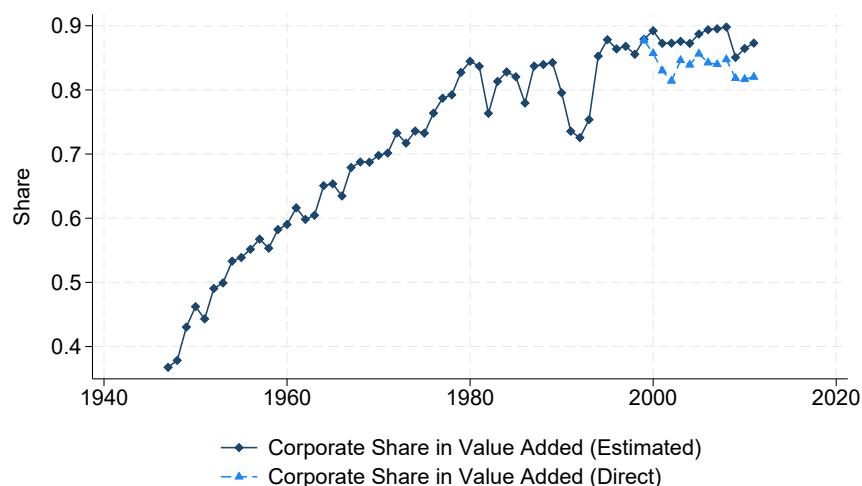


Figure DA3. Canada: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share in private business value added for Canada. The solid line with diamonds uses the ratio of corporate profits to corporate profits plus net income of unincorporated businesses (excluding imputed rents from owner-occupied housing). This estimate assumes that the ratio of compensation of employees to value added among corporations is the same as that among private businesses overall. The dashed line with triangles uses the ratio of corporate wages, salaries and employee benefits plus corporate profits, divided by wages, salaries and supplementary labor income from businesses and persons (from national accounts) plus corporate profits plus net income of unincorporated businesses (excluding imputed rents from owner-occupied housing).

net income of corporations and non-corporations in a given year (starting with net income of corporations and dividing by estimated corporate share as discussed above). Restricted to those with positive net income.

DA1.4 Denmark

Table DA4 lists the sources that we use for Denmark.

DA1.4.1 By Sales

Sources We use two types of tabulations by size of sales for Denmark. First, between 1970 and 1999, we use publications on value added tax (VAT) from Statistics Denmark. These tabulations were discontinued in 2000. We download PDFs from Statistics Denmark ([Danmarks Statistik, 1973-1981, 1983-2001a](#)), and transcribe the data. These tabulations are based on the business registry and VAT returns (the VAT was introduced in Denmark in 1967). Second, between 2000 and 2020, we directly obtain customized tabulations by sales from Statistics Denmark. These tabulations are compiled based on the Danish business register, and [Danmarks Statistik \(2020\)](#) explains the sample.

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is a VAT-reporting unit. The VAT-reporting unit is normally the legal entity, but a firm can choose to register under multiple VAT numbers, and firms

Table DA4 – Denmark: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by sales	1970–1999	Danmarks Statistik (various years) <i>Statistiske Efterretninger - Momsregistrerede Virksomheder</i> .
	2000–2020	Danmarks Statistik; directly obtained from the Business Statistics group at Danmarks Statistik.
Tabulations by equity capital	1902–1974	Danmarks Statistik (various years) <i>Statistisk Årbog</i> .
	1920–1931	Danmarks Statistik (various years) <i>Statistiske Meddelelser - Aktieselskaber</i> .
	1977–1983	Danmarks Statistik (various years) <i>Statistiske Efterretninger - Bestanden af Aktie og Anpartsselskaber</i> .
	1989–2018	Danmarks Statistik; directly obtained from the Business Statistics group at Danmarks Statistik.

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Danish data.

under common control may elect to register jointly as one unit. The minimum sales threshold was 5,000 Kroner in 1970 and 20,000 Kroner in 1999 ([Danmarks Statistik, 1973, 2001b](#)).

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is an enterprise, defined as the smallest combination of legal units forming an organizationally and financially autonomous entity. The tabulations are restricted to active non-agricultural businesses, with the definition of active businesses (industry-specific sales cutoffs) changing over time. This creates a large decline in the number of firms in 2000 and then again a large increase in 2019. We set a 100,000 Kroner threshold for the years up to 2000 and remove returns with zero or negative turnover for the years afterwards to generate a consistent firm count for the entire sample period.

Variable definition For the first source, sales capture total domestic sales and exports, but exclude other foreign activities of Danish firms. Certain types of economic activities are exempt from VAT (most of banking and insurance services, healthcare, private education, cultural services, and the long-term leasing of real estate). Sales in these sectors are only captured by the tax statistics if firms are required to submit a return (for example, due to additional taxable activities) or if they voluntarily file a tax return.

For the second source, sales capture total turnover as reported in firms' annual accounts. This measure is not restricted to activities that are liable for VAT. Domestic sales and exports are included, but the sales of foreign subsidiaries are not.

Figure [DA4](#) shows the coverage of the sales tabulations. The left panel shows log total sales from the tabulations. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales relative to GDP (solid line with

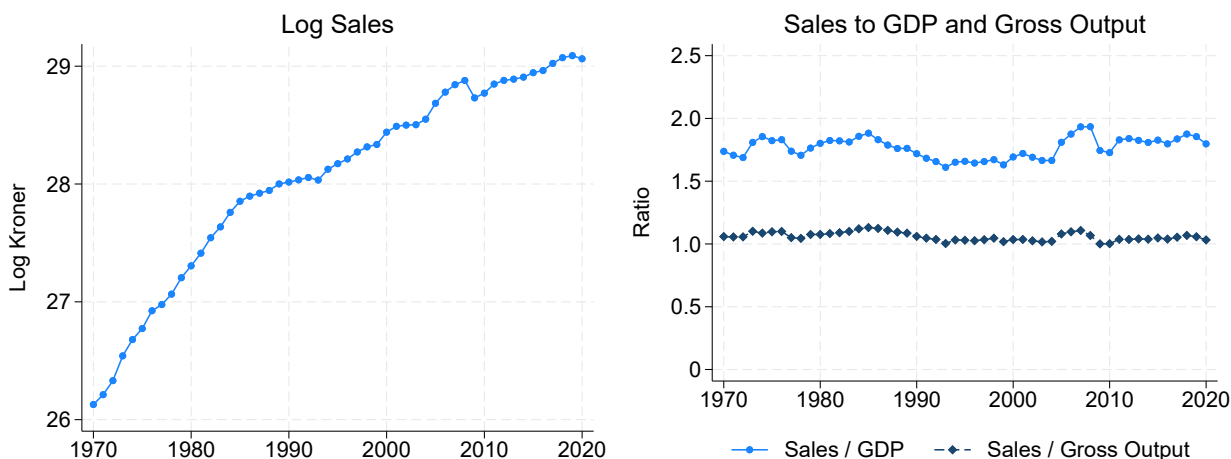


Figure DA4. Denmark: Coverage of Sales in Tax Statistics

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated sales in our data. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales to GDP (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). GDP data come from [Jordà, Schularick, and Taylor \(2017\)](#). Gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)).

circles) is around two, and relative to gross output (dashed line with diamonds) is around one. These comparisons show that our data have comprehensive and consistent coverage (gross output in national accounts—which is the counterpart of sales—is typically twice the level of GDP).

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share among top $y\%$ = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/Sales of top $y\%$ firms by sales in a given year.
- Top N sales share = Sales of top N firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.

DA1.4.2 By Equity Capital

Sources We have tabulations by size of equity capital for corporations since 1902 and limited liability companies (LLCs) after they were introduced in 1974, published by Statistics Denmark. First, between 1902 and 1983, these tabulations are regularly published in the *Statistisk Årbog* and in accompanying publications (with additional information) by Statistics Denmark. We download PDFs from the website of Statistics Denmark ([Danmarks Statistik, 1903-1975, 1928-1932, 1984-1987](#)), and transcribe the data. The tabulations are based on information from corporate register data. Second, between 1989 and 2018, we directly obtain customized estimates of top 1% and top 500 shares from Statistics Denmark ([Danmarks Statistik, 2025b](#)). These series are compiled on the basis of accounting data that Statistics Denmark recently acquired from the data provider KOB/Experian. The accounting data come from annual reports that all corporations and LLCs are required to file at the Danish Ministry of Economic

and Business Affairs (Bennedsen et al., 2007). We restrict the sample to firms with positive book equity.

Scope For both sources, the data cover corporations and LLCs. The unit of observation is the company as recorded in the company register, which records each legal entity separately. In 1977, a minimum capital size requirement of 100,000 Kroner for corporations and 30,000 Kroner for limited liability companies was introduced (Danmarks Statistik, 1984-1987). The thresholds were raised to 300,000 Kroner for corporations and 80,000 Kroner for LLCs in 1983, and 500,000 Kroner for corporations and 200,000 Kroner for LLCs in 1991; the thresholds were then reduced to 125,000 Kroner for LLCs in 1996, 80,000 Kroner in 2010, and 50,000 Kroner in 2014 (Danmarks Statistik, 1984-1987; Folketinget, 1991, 1996, 2009, 2013).

Variable definition For the first source, the data use the value of paid-in capital until 1964, and subscribed capital since 1965 (Danmarks Statistik, 1965). Subscribed capital is the total amount of shares that investors have agreed to purchase times their par value. Paid-in capital is the portion of that amount that has actually been paid to the firm. The two concepts are similar and comparable in magnitude (paid-in capital in 1964 was 7,972 million Kroner, and subscribed capital in 1965 was 8,622 million Kroner).

For the second source, the data are based on firms' reported book equity.

Corporate share Since the tabulations by capital are restricted to corporations and LLCs, we need to estimate the share of corporations and LLCs relative to all businesses (especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1). For 1948 to 2018, we estimate the corporate share using the sales share of corporations (all years) and LLCs (starting in 1974) in total sales, available from Statistics Denmark and census publications (Danmarks Statistik, 1973-1981, 1983-2001a, 1925-1958, 2025a). Before 1948, we can obtain estimates of the corporate employment share for industrials (Danmarks Statistik, 1908-1914, 1925-1958).⁴¹ The two estimates are both available in 1948, and align closely. We therefore use the employment share series to extend our corporate share series further back in time.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ capital share = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Capital of corporations (and LLCs) in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ capital share among top $y\%$ = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Capital of top $y\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year.
- Top N capital share = Capital of top N corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Estimated total capital in a given year (starting with capital of corporations and LLCs and dividing by their estimated share as discussed above).

⁴¹The industrials sector includes construction, manufacturing, utilities, and mining.

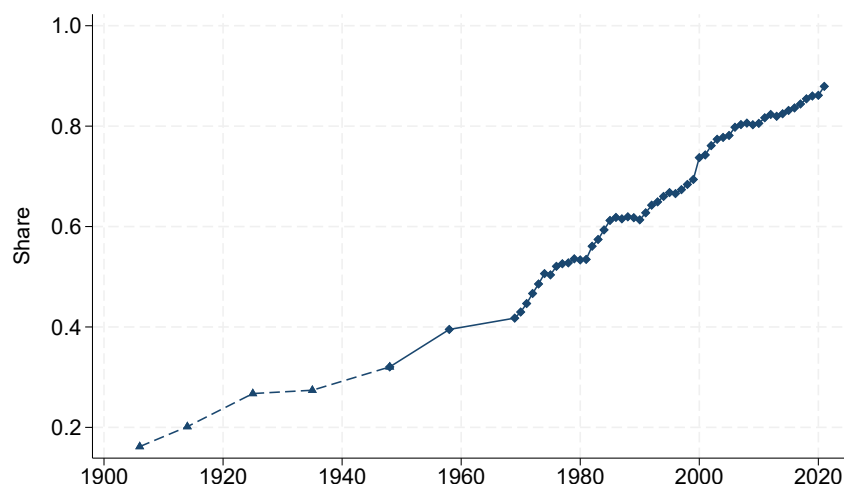


Figure DA5. Denmark: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share for Denmark. We use the sales share of corporations and LLCs (after their introduction in 1974) in total sales after 1948 (solid line with diamonds), and the employment share of industrial corporations among all industrial businesses before then (dashed line with triangles).

Table DA5 – France: Data Sources

Type		Period	Source
Tabulations sales	by	1949–1950	Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques (1949, 1950) <i>Bulletin Mensuel de Statistique</i> .
		1952–1979	Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques (various years) <i>Statistiques & Études Financières</i> .
		1981–1997	Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques (various years) <i>Annuaire Statistique de la France</i> .
Tabulations employment	by	1966, 1981–1997	Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques (various years) <i>Annuaire Statistique de la France</i> .
		1973	Brocard and Gandois (1978) <i>Grandes Entreprises et PME</i> . Economie et Statistique 96.1, 25-41.
		1975	Brocard (1979) <i>Les Entreprises Françaises. Concentration et Grandes Entreprises des Secteurs et des Branches</i> . Collections de l'INSEE. Série E. Entreprises 64.

Notes: This table lists the sources of the French data.

DA1.5 France

Table [DA5](#) lists the sources that we use for France.

DA1.5.1 By Sales

Sources We have tabulations by size of sales for industrial and commercial (Bénéfices Industriels et Commerciaux, or BIC) firms from 1949 to 1997, using data from the French statistical office (Insee). From 1952 to 1979, our main source is the *Statistiques & Études Financières*. For 1949 and 1950, we are able to find additional data from *Bulletin Mensuel de Statistique*. Data after 1979 come from the *Annuaire Statistique de la France* which draws on the SUSE (“Système Unifié de Statistique d’Entreprise”) database. Currently we stop in 1997 because size tabulations up to this point include finance but exclude it afterwards. We obtain physical books of *Statistiques & Études Financières* from the University of Chicago Library ([Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques, 1954-1984](#)), and download PDFs of *Annuaire Statistique de la France* and *Bulletin Mensuel de Statistique* from Gallica ([Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques, 1952-1953, 1954-2000](#)), which is the digital library of the French national library. We then transcribe the data. The tabulations are based on information from the corporate tax and the personal income tax on industrial and commercial profits.

Scope The data cover industrial and commercial (Bénéfices Industriels et Commerciaux, or BIC) firms. Non-commercial (Bénéfices Non Commerciaux, or BNC) firms (e.g., self-employed professionals like doctors and lawyers) and agriculture (Bénéfices Agricoles, or BA) firms are excluded. Each unit is a siren (Système d’Identification du Répertoire des Entreprises). From 1981, the tabulations by size only included large firms that belong to the Bénéfices Réels Normal (BRN) tax regime, but not smaller firms that belong to the Régime Réel Simplifié d’Imposition (RSI) tax regime; before then both types were combined in the Bénéfices Réels (BR) tax regime and included in the tabulations by size. The tabulations by size of sales do not cover firms that belong to the Forfait (FORF) tax regime, which are small in size. To maintain consistency, in years when RSI or FORF firms are not included in the size tabulations, we assign all of them to the size bin that corresponds to their average size.⁴² This assumption should not affect top share estimates because RSI and FORF firms by definition have low sales, so they matter little for the numerator of top shares.

Variable definition Sales are defined as the total revenue generated by a firm in French territories, including exports.

Figure DA6 shows the coverage of the dataset. The left panel shows log total sales from the tabulations. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales relative to GDP (solid line with circles) is around two, and relative to gross output (dashed line with diamonds) is around one in years when we can find gross output data. These comparisons show that our data have comprehensive coverage (gross output in national accounts—which is the counterpart of sales—is typically twice the level of GDP).

Data construction

⁴²We obtain the total number and sales of RSI and FORF firms from tables on the totals by tax regime in the same publications.

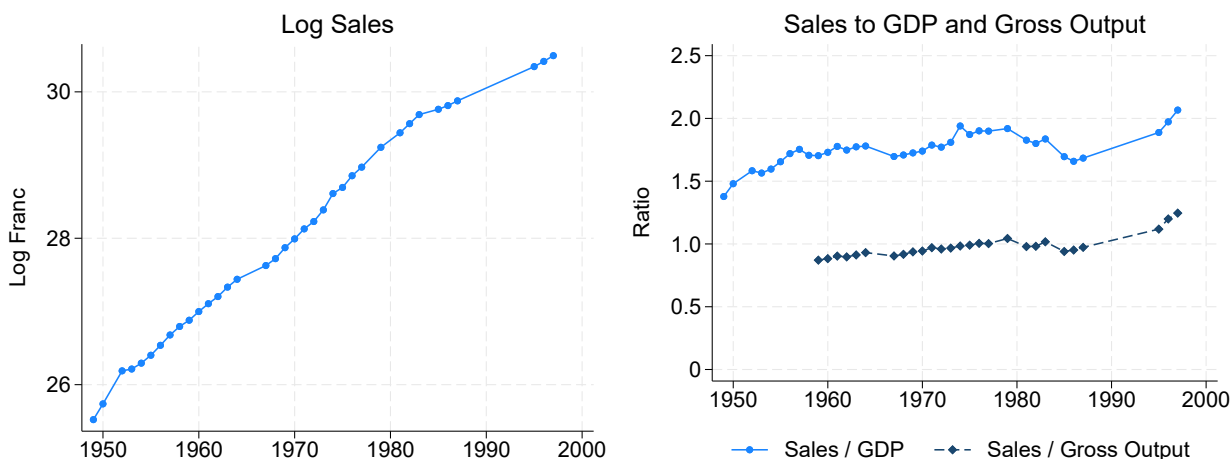


Figure DA6. France: Coverage of Sales in Tax Statistics

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated sales in our data. The data are expressed in USD equivalents to allow for comparability between Old Franc, New Franc and Euro values. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales to GDP (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). GDP data come from [Jordà, Schularick, and Taylor \(2017\)](#). Gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)).

- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share among top $y\%$ = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/Sales of top $y\%$ firms by sales in a given year.
- Top N sales share = Sales of top N firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.

DA1.5.2 By Employment

Sources We have tabulations by size of employment for industrial and commercial (Bénéfices Industriels et Commerciaux, or BIC) firms from 1966 to 1997, using data from the French statistical office (Insee). Data for 1966 come from an early version of the French business registry (Fichier des Entreprises et des Établissements). We download PDFs from Gallica ([Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques, 1954-2000](#)), and then transcribe the data. Data for 1973 and 1975 come from businesses' fiscal declarations. We download PDFs from Persée ([Brocard and Gandois, 1978](#); [Brocard, 1979](#)), which is a digital open access library by the French Ministry of Education, and then transcribe the data. Data for 1981 to 1997 come from the *Annuaire Statistique de la France* publication, which we also use for the tabulations by sales and is based on the SUSE database ("Système Unifié de Statistique d'Entreprise"). We download PDFs from Gallica ([Institut National de la Statistique et des Études Économiques, 1954-2000](#)), and then transcribe the data.

Scope The data cover industrial and commercial (Bénéfices Industriels et Commerciaux, or BIC) firms. Non-commercial (Bénéfices Non Commerciaux, or BNC) firms (e.g., self-employed profession-

als) and agriculture (Bénéfices Agricoles, or BA) firms are excluded.⁴³ Each unit is a siren (Système d'Identification du Répertoire des Entreprises), which is the same as in the tabulations by sales. From 1981, the tabulations by size only included large firms that belong to the Bénéfices Réels Normal (BRN) tax regime, but not smaller firms that belong to the Régime Réel Simplifié d'Imposition (RSI) tax regime; before then both types were combined in the Bénéfices Réels (BR) tax regime and included in the tabulations by size. The tabulations by size of employment included firms that belong to the Forfait (FORF) tax regime until 1980, but not afterwards. To maintain consistency, in years when RSI or FORF firms are not included in the size tabulations, we assign all of them to the size bin that corresponds to their average size.⁴⁴ This assumption should not affect top share estimates because RSI and FORF firms by definition are small, so they matter little for the numerator of top shares.

Variable definition Employment includes all individuals who reported being salaried workers and who are not classified as self-employed or employers. The classification is based solely on the legal status of having a paid employment relationship with an employer, rather than on working hours or contract duration. This definition covers all wage-earning workers regardless of whether they are full-time or part-time, permanent or temporary.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ employment share = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by employment in a given year/Total employment in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ employment share among top $y\%$ = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by employment in a given year/Employment of top $y\%$ firms by employment in a given year.
- Top N employment share = Employment of top N firms by employment in a given year/Total employment in a given year.

DA1.6 Germany

Table DA6 lists the sources that we use for Germany.

Table DA6 – Germany: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by sales	1926–1929	Statistisches Reichsamt (various years) <i>Statistik des Deutschen Reichs Band 361 and 399 - Umsatz und Umsatzsteuer in Deutschland</i> .
	1935	Statistisches Reichsamt (1938) <i>Statistik des Deutschen Reichs Band 511 - Umsatzsteuerstatistik 1935</i> .

⁴³We have to drop the data for 1977 to 1980 because these years provide tabulations combining BIC, BNC, and BA firms, which we cannot separate, whereas all other years tabulate BIC firms only.

⁴⁴We obtain the total number and employment of RSI and FORF firms from tables on the totals by tax regime in the same publications.

	1950–1959	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Die Umsätze der Umsatzsteuerpflichtigen und deren Besteuerung.</i>
	1960–1974	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Finanzen und Steuern Fachserie L Reihe 7 - Umsatzsteuer.</i>
	1976–2009	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Finanzen und Steuern Fachserie 14 Reihe 8 - Umsatzsteuer.</i>
	2010–2019	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Finanzen und Steuern Fachserie 14 Reihe 8.1 - Umsatzsteuerstatistik (Vorankündigungen).</i>
CR10 by sales (manufacturing)	1954–1982	Statistisches Bundesamt (1985) <i>Konzentrationsstatistische Daten für den Bergbau und das Verarbeitende Gewerbe, Fachserie 4 Reihe S.9.</i>
	1983–2016	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Konzentrationsstatistische Daten für den Bergbau und das Verarbeitende Gewerbe sowie das Baugewerbe, Fachserie 4 Reihe 4.2.3.</i>
	2017–2021	Statistisches Bundesamt (2025) <i>Konzentration der Unternehmen nach Wirtschaftszweigen.</i>
Tabulations by equity capital	1904–1920	Königlich Statistisches Bureau (various years) <i>Statistisches Jahrbuch für den Preussischen Staat.</i>
	1936–1941	Statistisches Reichsamt (various years) <i>Wirtschaft und Statistik.</i>
	1955–1980	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Wirtschaft und Statistik.</i>
	1956, 1959	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Statistisches Jahrbuch der Bundesrepublik Deutschland.</i> Used to fill in gaps.
	1983–1992	Statistisches Bundesamt (various years) <i>Unternehmen und Arbeitsstätten Fachserie 2 Reihe 2.2 - Zahl und Nominalkapital der Kapitalgesellschaften.</i>
Tabulations by employment	1925	Statistisches Reichsamt (1930) <i>Statistik des Deutschen Reichs Band 413, IV - Gewerbliche Betriebszählung - Die gewerblichen Betriebe und Unternehmungen im Deutschen Reich, Teil IV.</i>
	1961	Statistisches Bundesamt (1965) <i>Unternehmen und Arbeitsstätten Fachserie C - Arbeitsstättenzählung von 6. Juni 1961, Heft 4 Nichtlandwirtschaftliche Unternehmen (Wirtschaftseinheiten) und Beschäftigte.</i>
	1970, 1987	Statistisches Bundesamt (1990) <i>Unternehmen und Arbeitsstätten Fachserie 2 - Arbeitsstättenzählung vom 25. Mai 1987, Heft 11 Arbeitsstätten, Unternehmen und Beschäftigte 1987, 1970, 1961, 1950.</i>
	2003–2018	Statistisches Bundesamt (2025) <i>Statistisches Unternehmensregister, Rechtliche Einheiten nach Sondergrößenklassen der Beschäftigten.</i>

Notes: This table lists the sources of the German data.

DA1.6.1 By Sales

Sources We use tabulations by size of sales for all types of firms from 1926 to 2019, published by the German statistical office. We obtain physical books of the publications before 1935 through the German National Library ([Statistisches Reichsamt, 1931, 1932, 1938](#)), and download PDFs through the statistical library of the Statistisches Bundesamt afterwards ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1955-1961, 1962-1976, 1978-2011, 2012-2022a](#)). We then transcribe the data. The tabulations are based on information from the sales tax (first introduced in 1916 on the delivery of all goods, and expanded to cover all goods and services in 1918) and the value added tax (VAT) (following additional reforms that led to the transition in 1967). The German statistical office published regular reports based on submitted tax records including tabulations of businesses by size of sales since 1924. We restrict our analysis to data from 1926 onward because tabulations for 1924 and 1925 exclude tax-exempt sales (e.g., exports).

Scope The data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is a VAT or sales tax payer. If multiple businesses are financially, economically, and organizationally integrated, they file a joint VAT return (except for 1945 to 1958). Firms have to pay VAT (sales tax before 1968) if their sales exceed a pre-specified threshold. The threshold was 8,000 Deutsche Mark in 1958, 20,000 Deutsche Mark in 1980, and 17,500 Euros by 2003 ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1955-1961, 1978-2011](#)). The tabulations in some years before 1958 have a minimum threshold while others do not. For the years when there is no minimum threshold, we impose one ourselves to maximize consistency over time. For the years between 1955 and 1958, we set this threshold to 8,000 Deutsche Mark to be consistent with later years. For 1950, we set the threshold to 6,000 Deutsche Mark (since 8,000 is not a size bin threshold in that year). For the years until 1935 that use a different currency, we set this threshold to 5,000 Reichsmark. Before 1945, the tax statistics include firms from the entire German Reich. After 1945, the statistics cover West Germany. West Berlin is included from 1957 onward, the Saarland from 1960 onward, and East Germany from 1992 onward.

Variable definition The tax statistics tabulate firms based on total sales in Germany.⁴⁵ This includes taxable sales and tax-exempt sales, such as exports.⁴⁶ Certain types of economic activities are exempt from VAT (most of banking and insurance services, healthcare, private education, cultural services, and the long-term leasing of real estate). Sales in these sectors are only captured by the tax statistics if firms are required to submit a return (for example, due to additional taxable activities or imports from another EU country) or if they voluntarily file a tax return. In addition, tax-exempt banking and

⁴⁵Sales tax statistics in Germany have two different underlying sources. One is “*voranmeldungen*,” which is pre-registration that firms have to file at regular intervals during the year. The other is “*veranlagungen*,” which is final tax assessment from firms’ tax returns submitted at the end of the fiscal year. The advantage of pre-registration statistics is that they can usually be published much faster. The main difference is that pre-registrations are only filed by firms that exceeded the tax threshold in the previous year, and thus exclude entrants and firms with sales below the exemption threshold in the previous year. Assessment statistics are available from 2006 onward and until 1950. We use assessment statistics until 1950 and, for consistency and to avoid changing sources, pre-registration statistics after 1950.

⁴⁶Imports are subject to sales tax (*Einfuhrumsatzsteuer*), but not covered by the statistics.

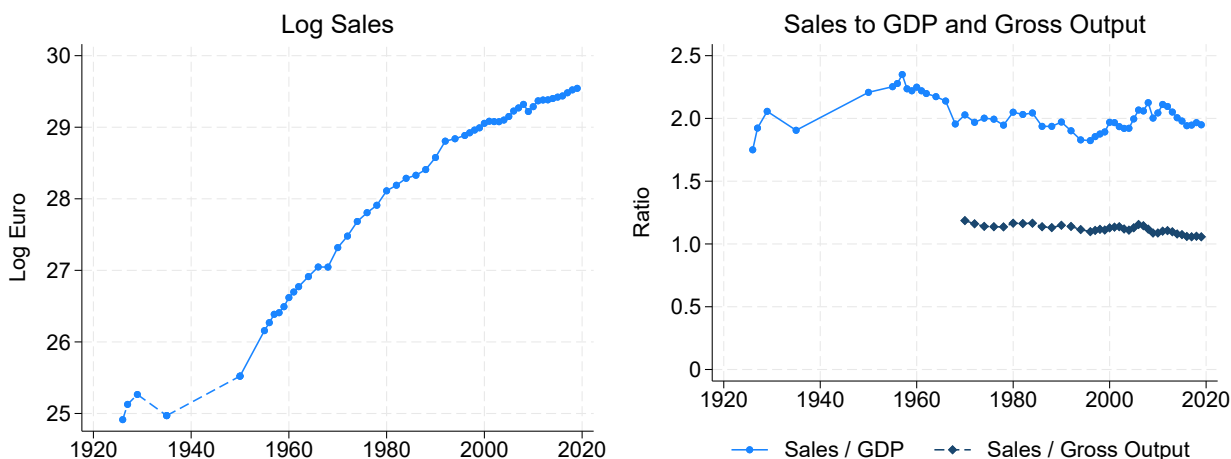


Figure DA7. Germany: Coverage of Sales in Tax Statistics

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated sales in our data. The data are expressed in Euro equivalents. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales to GDP (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). Data for East Germany are included from 1992 onward. GDP data come from [Jordà, Schularick, and Taylor \(2017\)](#) for 1950 onwards (in Deutsche Mark) and [Ritschl and Spoerer \(1997\)](#) for the earlier years (in Reichsmark). Gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)). Before 2000, we convert the Deutsche Mark to Euro with a rate of 1 Euro = 1.95583 Mark. To plot log sales before and after World War II in a single figure, we assume a one-to-one exchange rate between the Reichsmark and the Deutsche Mark, consistent with the one-to-one conversion rate of wages during the 1948 currency reform.

insurance sales are generally eliminated from the published statistical results (even if firms report them in tax returns and tax-exempt sales are otherwise included in the by sales tabulations).

Figure DA7 shows the coverage of tabulated sales in our data. The left panel shows log total sales from the tabulations. The integration of East Germany did not create a sizable discontinuity, as the East German economy was small relative to the West German economy. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales relative to GDP (solid line with circles) is around two, and relative to gross output (dashed line with diamonds) is around one in years when we can find gross output data. These comparisons show that our data have comprehensive and consistent coverage (gross output in national accounts—which is the counterpart of sales—is typically twice the level of GDP).

Sector harmonization The German tax statistics include tabulations by sector. We use these sectoral tabulations to estimate top shares in manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade, and services, which are roughly comparable with SIC codes 20-39 (manufacturing), 50-59 (retail/wholesale trade), and 70-89 (services). The statistical office periodically updated its sector classifications, requiring some adjustments to create sectors that are as consistent as possible over the long run. For manufacturing, we exclude “Mining,” “Metal extraction,” and “Stone, ceramics, glass extraction and processing” (which were sometimes mixed with mining) to obtain a consistent series. For services, the definitions of the services subsectors (which we combine to obtain one series for services as a whole) changed over time,

with particularly significant adjustments in 1968 and 2009. We stop in 2009 to be able to exclude telecommunications consistently from services. We exclude healthcare prior to 1968 due to inconsistent coverage following the adoption of the VAT. Before 1968, healthcare included both institutional providers and independent practitioners. After 1968, only institutional providers remained. Therefore, the number of firms in the healthcare sector is not comparable before and after the change. We exclude “Asset Management Firms” from 1962 to 1998 to match with the coverage of the services sector before 1961; due to limited data granularity, “Asset Management Firms” cannot be excluded for the period of 1999 to 2008. We also exclude “Political and Economic Organizations,” “Religious Organizations,” and “Sovereign and Chamber Administrations” from the entire series. Due to limited data granularity, “Religious Organizations” cannot be excluded from 1999 to 2008, but it represents only a small share of the services sector and does not affect the overall concentration trends.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share among top $y\%$ = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/Sales of top $y\%$ firms by sales in a given year.
- Top N sales share = Sales of top N firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.

DA1.6.2 CR10 by Sales

Sources We have data on CR10 reported for two-digit manufacturing industries since 1954, and for four-digit manufacturing industries since 1968. The data come from reports by the Federal Cartel Office and the Monopolies Commission for 1954 to 1982 ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1985](#)), and the German statistical office’s Fachserie 4.2.3 publications for 1983 to 2016 ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1986-2018a](#)); we download PDFs from the statistical library of the Statistisches Bundesamt, and transcribe the data. The publication of the Fachserie was discontinued in 2016, and we obtain updated files for 2017 to 2021 directly from the German statistical office ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 2017-2021](#)).⁴⁷

Scope The data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit is the smallest domestic legal entity obliged to keep books and prepare annual accounts. The data for 1954 to 1975 are restricted to firms with 10 or more workers ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1985](#)). The data for 1976 to today are restricted to firms with 20 or more workers ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1985, 1986-2018a, 2017-2021](#)). Census data on firm size by employment (see Data Appendix Section [DA1.6.4](#)) show that the share of employment in firms with fewer than 20 workers has declined over time. As a result, concentration statistics restricted to firms with at least 20 workers likely cover a larger share of activity now than in the past, which may understate the increase in CR10. At the start, in 1954, the statistics cover West Germany and West Berlin. The Saarland is included from 1955 onward,

⁴⁷In addition, the German statistical office provided us with an internal version of the Fachserie 4.2.3 (which includes the concentration statistics) for 2007 and 2008, which was based on the industry classification WZ2003. The published version available online uses the WZ2008 classification but does not include data for 2007.

and East Germany from 1991 onward.

Variable definition Sales are defined as the value of invoiced deliveries and services to third parties, excluding VAT. They include revenue from own products and services but exclude non-operating income like asset sales, interest income, and dividends.

DA1.6.3 By Equity Capital

Sources We have tabulations by size of equity capital for corporations and limited liability companies (LLCs) from 1936 to 1992, published by the German statistical office based on public filings with the commercial register. Corporations and LLCs are tabulated separately. Tabulations for corporations are published more regularly than the corresponding tabulations for LLCs. We restrict our analysis to years when tabulations for both groups are available. We download PDFs through the statistical library of the Statistisches Bundesamt ([Statistisches Reichsamt, 1937-1942](#); [Statistisches Bundesamt, 1956-1981, 1957-1960, 1987-1994](#)), and transcribe the data.

To extend the German data further back in time, we add tabulations for both corporations and LLCs for Prussian firms from 1904 to 1920 published by the Prussian statistical office. Prussia accounted for about 60% of the German population at that time and Prussian data are often used to extend series for Germany further back in time (see [Albers, Bartels, and Schularick, 2026](#)). We download PDFs from HathiTrust ([Königliches Statistisches Landesamt, 1905-1923](#)) and then transcribe the data.

Scope The data cover corporations and LLCs. The unit of observation is a firm registered as either a corporation or an LLC in the commercial register. The law stipulates a minimum amount of nominal capital for both legal forms. For corporations, a minimum nominal capital threshold was imposed implicitly at 5,000 Mark in 1884. In 1923, a legal minimum nominal capital threshold of 5,000 Goldmark for existing firms and 50,000 Goldmark for new firms was introduced. In 1937, the National Socialist government increased the minimum nominal capital threshold to 500,000 Reichsmark in an effort to force conversions to other legal forms. After the war, the minimum amount of capital for corporations was set at 100,000 Deutsche Mark ([Bayer and Habersack, 2007](#)). For LLCs, the minimum capital was originally set at 20,000 Mark when the legal form was introduced in 1892. This amount remained unchanged across the various currency regimes until 1980, when it was raised to 50,000 Deutsche Mark ([Untergrabner, 2009](#)). Firms were granted a grace period to raise their nominal capital or to convert to another legal form whenever the statutory minimum was increased. Data between 1904 and 1920 are restricted to Prussia. Data for 1936 to 1941 cover the entire German Reich. Starting in 1955, the statistics cover West Germany. The Saarland is included since 1962, West Berlin since 1964, and East Germany since 1992.

Variable definition The German tabulations by capital use the value of nominal capital. Nominal capital is defined as the total amount of shares multiplied by their par value.

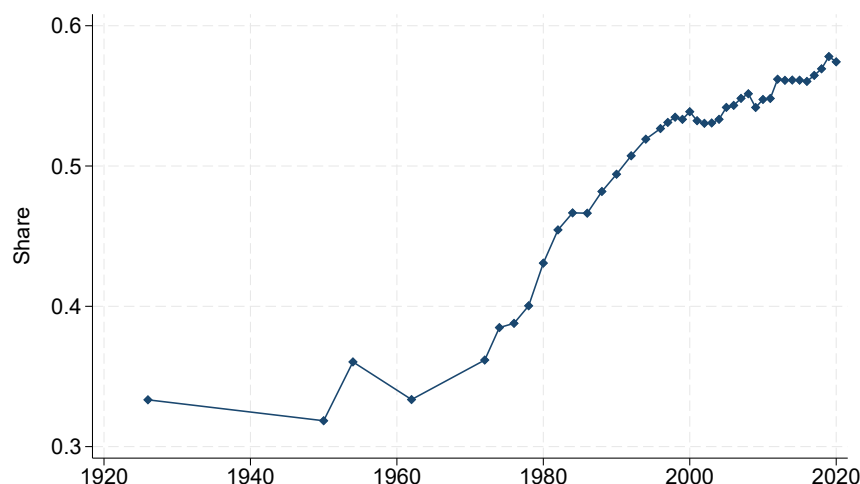


Figure DA8. Germany: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share for Germany. We use the sales share of corporations and LLCs in total sales.

Corporate share Since the tabulations by capital are restricted to corporations and LLCs, we need to estimate their share relative to all businesses (especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1). We estimate the corporate share using the sales share of corporations and LLCs in total sales from sales tax statistics. The resulting corporate share series is shown in Figure DA8.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ capital share = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year/Capital of corporations (and LLCs) in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ capital share among top $y\%$ = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year/Capital of top $y\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year.
- Top N capital share = Capital of top N corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year/Estimated total capital in a given year (starting with capital of corporations and LLCs and dividing by their estimated share as discussed above).

DA1.6.4 By Employment

Sources We use two types of tabulations by size of employment for Germany. First, between 1925 and 1987, we have tabulations from the Census of Establishments, which was conducted at irregular intervals approximately every 10 to 15 years during this time period. We obtain physical books of pre-1961 Census of Establishments publications from the German National Library ([Statistisches Reichsamt, 1930](#)), and download PDF files for the 1961, 1970, and 1987 censuses from the statistical library of the Statistisches Bundesamt ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1965, 1990](#)). No firm-level employment

size tabulations are available for the 1933, 1939, and 1950 censuses.⁴⁸ Second, for 2003 to 2018, the data come from the company register managed by the German statistical office ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 2003-2022b, 2025](#)). The statistical office maintains and updates the register using information from tax authorities, the federal employment agency, surveys, and commercial data providers. The statistical office kindly provided us with detailed tabulations for all years.

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is a company, defined as the smallest legal unit that maintains financial records for business or tax purposes. Companies (or “economic units” as they are called in early issues of the census) can either be single establishment firms or the aggregation of several establishments that belong to the same legally independent enterprise. The Census of Establishments covers all non-agricultural firms and their employees, and the tabulations include their data for all domestic establishments (even if the establishments engage in agricultural activities). Before 1945, the statistics include firms from the entire German Reich. After 1945, the statistics cover West Germany (including West Berlin).

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is a legal unit. A legal entity is included in the register if it has at least one employee subject to social security contributions, or if its annual revenue exceeds the VAT registration threshold described in Data Appendix Section [DA1.6.1](#) ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 2018b](#)). The company register includes businesses from all sectors, except agriculture, public administration, and extraterritorial entities. The data from 2003 to 2005 are based on the industry classification WZ 2003. Later years are classified based on WZ 2008, which may have resulted in small changes in the population of firms, even at the aggregate level according to the statistical office.

Variable definition For the first source, employees include all full-time and part-time workers who are in an employment relationship on the reference date and are listed on the payroll. This also includes active owners and unpaid assisting family members, regardless of the number of hours they work at the workplace.

For the second source, employees include all workers subject to social security contributions (i.e., those earning above a minimum threshold). Self-employed and working owners are excluded unless registered as employees subject to social security contributions (e.g., an LLC managing director with a salary). This narrower definition of employees tends to raise top employment shares by a small amount between 2003 and 2018.

Sector harmonization The Census of Establishments and the company register include tabulations of firms by sector and employment size. We use these sectoral tabulations to estimate top shares in manufacturing and retail/wholesale trade, which are roughly comparable with SIC codes 20-39

⁴⁸The 1933 census publications omitted firm size tabulations. A planned 1939 census volume on firm-level statistics was never published. The 1950 census publications only tabulated firm size based on sales rather than employment.

Table DA7 – Singapore: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by net income	1972–2004	Inland Revenue Department (various years) <i>Yearbook of Statistics, Singapore</i> .
	2005–2022	Inland Revenue Authority of Singapore (various years) <i>Taxable Companies by Assessed Income Group</i> .

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Singaporean data.

(manufacturing) and 50–59 (retail/wholesale trade). Sectoral classifications were updated over our sample period, requiring some adjustments to create sectors that are as consistent as possible over the long run. We make sure that manufacturing always excludes construction, mining, and utilities. Trade typically includes retail, wholesale, and trade brokerage. The company register also groups firms classified as automobile repair shops under trade, a category that falls under manufacturing in the census and cannot be isolated in either source due to insufficient sectoral detail.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ employment share = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by employment in a given year/Total employment in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ employment share among top $y\%$ = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by employment in a given year/Employment of top $y\%$ firms by employment in a given year.
- Top N employment share = Employment of top N firms by employment in a given year/Total employment in a given year.

DA1.7 Singapore

Table DA7 lists the sources that we use for Singapore.

Sources We have tabulations by size of taxable income for corporations since 1972, published by the Department of Statistics using data from the Inland Revenue Department before 1992 and the Inland Revenue Authority afterwards. We obtain tabulations from PDFs of the *Yearbook of Statistics* on the website of the Singapore National Library before 2005 ([Singapore Department of Statistics, 1972–2004](#)), and transcribe the data; we download data in Excel spreadsheets from the website of the Inland Revenue Authority of Singapore (IRAS) since 2005 ([Inland Revenue Authority of Singapore, 2005–2007, 2008–2022](#)). These tabulations are based on corporate income tax returns.

Scope The tabulations include resident and nonresident corporations with positive income. They do not include partnerships, sole proprietorships, trusts, and associations (including cooperatives).

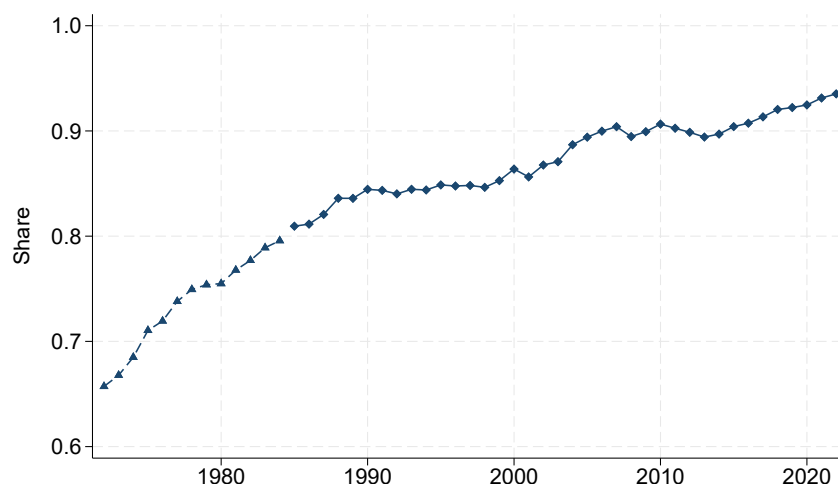


Figure DA9. Singapore: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share for Singapore. We use the ratio of corporate GDP to corporate and non-corporate GDP since 1985 (solid line with diamonds), and the five-year moving average of corporate assessed income to corporate plus non-corporate (partnership and sole proprietorship) assessed income (dashed line with triangles) between 1972 and 1985.

Variable definition Before 2005, the data are tabulated by assessed income. From 2005 onward, tabulations are by chargeable income (taxable income). There is no major discontinuity in the totals when the variable definition changes from assessed to chargeable income between 2004 and 2005. For residents, foreign-sourced income is taxable and included in the data if it is received in Singapore or brought back to Singapore.

Corporate share Since firm size tabulations for Singapore are restricted to corporations, we need to estimate the share of corporations relative to all businesses (especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1). We can use data from national accounts from the Singapore Department of Statistics ([Singapore Department of Statistics, 1985-2022](#)) from 1985 onward, by taking the ratio of corporate sector GDP to corporate plus non-corporate GDP. We use data on assessed income by legal form from the *Yearbook of Statistics* between 1972 and 1985, by taking the ratio of corporate assessed income to corporate plus non-corporate (partnership and sole proprietorship) assessed income ([Singapore Department of Statistics, 1972-2004](#)); we take five-year moving averages of this series to make it more stable. The resulting corporate share series is shown in Figure [DA9](#).

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ net income share = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of corporations in a given year. Restricted to those with positive net income.
- Top $x\%$ net income share among top $y\%$ = Net income of top $x\%$ corporations by net income in a given year/Net income of top $y\%$ corporations by net income in a given year. Restricted to those

with positive net income.

- Top N net income share = Net income of top N corporations by net income in a given year / Estimated net income of corporations and non-corporations in a given year (starting with net income of corporations and dividing by estimated corporate share as discussed above). Restricted to those with positive net income.

DA1.8 Switzerland

Table DA8 lists the sources that we use for Switzerland.

DA1.8.1 By Sales

Sources We use two types of tabulations by size of sales. First, the Swiss statistical office published a tabulation of firms by sales size as part of the 1965 Establishment Census. We download PDFs from the Swiss statistical office ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1967](#)), and transcribe the data (Data Appendix Section DA1.8.3 also uses this source). Second, we have tabulations by size of sales for all types of firms since 1995, published by the Federal Tax Administration in an annual publication of value added tax (VAT) statistics. We download PDFs from the Swiss statistical office ([Eidgenössische Steuerverwaltung, 1997-2023](#)), and transcribe the data. The tabulations are based on information from the VAT (introduced in Switzerland in 1995).

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation is a firm, defined as the smallest legally independent economic unit. The tabulation by sales from the 1965 Establishment Census includes all businesses in Switzerland, excluding agriculture, banking and insurance.

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation consists of a legal entity or a group of entities registered as a single taxpayer that submits standard monthly, quarterly, or semi-annual tax returns. If multiple entities are under unified management, they can file a joint VAT return (management is considered unified when control is exercised through a majority of votes or other means). Businesses with an annual turnover above the threshold must register in the VAT register and submit periodic declarations to the Federal Tax Administration. The minimum sales threshold was 75,000 Swiss Francs in 1995 and 100,000 Swiss Francs in 2010 ([Eidgenössische Steuerverwaltung, 1997, 2013](#)). However, there are many firms below the threshold still filing a VAT return (e.g., 17.8% of returns in 2015).

Variable definition For the first source, sales include all income from business activities, excluding taxes, subsidies, asset sales, and cost deductions. Firms with foreign branches report only revenue from Swiss operations. During the processing, the statistical office had to exclude a substantial share of firms because, due to a misunderstanding in the form, many firms reported net profits instead of sales ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1967](#)).

For the second source, the sales data use total sales of Swiss firms, including their foreign sales. This

Table DA8 – Switzerland: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by sales	1965	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1967) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz Heft 409, Reihe Df 1, Unternehmungen Hauptergebnisse für die Schweiz.</i>
	1995–2021	Eidgenössische Steuerverwaltung (various years) <i>Die Mehrwertsteuer in der Schweiz.</i>
Tabulations by equity capital	1901–1930	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1934) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz / Heft 56 - Schweizerische Aktiengesellschaften 1921 bis 1933.</i>
	1921–1985	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (various years) <i>Statistisches Jahrbuch der Schweiz.</i>
Tabulations by employment	1929	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1933) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz Heft 29, Die Unternehmungen in der Schweiz, Band 5 der Eidgenössischen Betriebszählung 1929.</i>
	1939	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1946) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz Heft 171, Die Unternehmungen in der Schweiz.</i>
	1955	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1965) <i>Statistisches Jahrbuch der Schweiz 1965.</i>
	1965	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1967) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz Heft 409, Reihe Df 1, Unternehmungen Hauptergebnisse für die Schweiz.</i>
	1975	Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt (1977) <i>Statistische Quellenwerke der Schweiz Heft 606, Eidgenössische Betriebszählung 1975 Unternehmungen, Hauptergebnisse für die Schweiz.</i>
	1985–1991	Bundesamt für Statistik (1994) <i>Die Wirtschaftliche Entwicklung im Spiegel der Betriebszählung 1985 und 1991.</i>
	1991–2008	Bundesamt für Statistik (2025) <i>Betriebszählung, 1991 bis 2008.</i>
	2011–2022	Bundesamt für Statistik (2025) <i>Institutionelle Einheiten (Unternehmen) Marktwirtschaftlich nach Grössenklasse und Wirtschaftssektor.</i>

Notes: This table lists the sources of the Swiss data.

is different from the tabulations by sales in Austria, Germany, and Denmark, which do not include foreign sales. Certain types of economic activities are exempt from VAT (most of banking and insurance

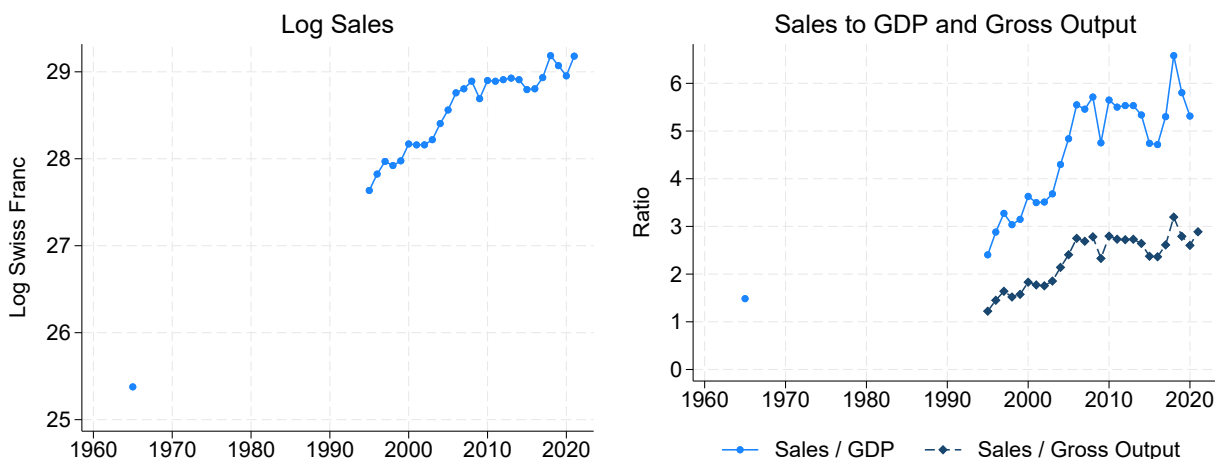


Figure DA10. Switzerland: Coverage of Sales in Tax Statistics

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated sales in our data. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales to GDP (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). GDP data come from [Jordà, Schularick, and Taylor \(2017\)](#). Gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)).

services, healthcare, private education, cultural services, and the long-term leasing of real estate). Sales in these sectors are only captured by the tax statistics if firms are required to submit a return (for example, due to additional taxable activities) or if they voluntarily file a tax return. However, the statistical office acknowledges in its documentation of the tax statistics that firms may not always report tax-exempt sales accurately on their tax returns.

Figure DA10 shows the coverage of the sales tabulations. The left panel shows log total sales from the tabulations. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated sales relative to GDP (solid line with circles), and relative to gross output (dashed line with diamonds). The ratios are higher than those in other countries, especially in recent years. This is likely due to the rise of foreign sales (which are not part of GDP or gross output), which are present in Swiss data but not in other by sales tabulations.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share among top $y\%$ = Sales of top $x\%$ firms by sales in a given year/Sales of top $y\%$ firms by sales in a given year.
- Top N sales share = Sales of top N firms by sales in a given year/All sales in a given year.

DA1.8.2 By Equity Capital

Sources We have tabulations by size of equity capital for corporations from 1901 and limited liability companies (LLCs) after they were introduced in 1937, until these tabulations ended in 1985, published by the Swiss statistical office. The publications are based on analyses of corporations and LLCs recorded

in the Business and Enterprise Register.⁴⁹ Corporations and LLCs are tabulated separately. Tabulations for corporations are published more regularly than the corresponding tabulations for LLCs. We restrict our analysis to years when tabulations for both groups are available. We download PDFs from the Statistical Yearbook and special issues on joint stock corporations published by the Federal Statistical Office ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1934, 1922-1986](#)); we then transcribe the data.

Scope The data cover corporations and LLCs. The unit of observation is a legal entity registered as a corporation or an LLC in the Business and Enterprise Register. Thus, the data are generally recorded on an unconsolidated basis, with each legal entity considered separately. In 1937 a 50,000 Swiss Francs minimum capital requirement was introduced for newly formed corporations and 20,000 Francs for LLCs ([Federal Government of Switzerland, 1936](#)). Corporations with less capital continued to operate, but gradually disappeared in the 1940s ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1947](#)), and disappeared entirely by 1952 ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1953](#)).

Variable definition The Swiss tabulations by capital use the value of nominal capital. Nominal capital is defined as the total amount of shares multiplied by their par value.

Corporate share Since the tabulations by capital are restricted to corporations and LLCs, we need to estimate the share of corporations and LLCs relative to all businesses (especially relevant for the top N shares in Section 3.1). After 1929, we can obtain data on the employment share of corporations and LLCs (after they were introduced in 1937) from the Federal Business Census for benchmark years ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1933-1998](#)); we linearly interpolate the employment share for years in between. Before 1929, we extend the series further back in time using a linear extrapolation based on the proportion of corporations among all registered businesses from the Historical Statistics of Switzerland ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1934](#)). The resulting series is shown in Figure DA11.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ capital share = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Capital of corporations (and LLCs) in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ capital share among top $y\%$ = Capital of top $x\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Capital of top $y\%$ corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year.
- Top N capital share = Capital of top N corporations (and LLCs) by capital in a given year / Estimated total capital in a given year (starting with capital of corporations and LLCs and dividing by their estimated share as discussed above).

DA1.8.3 By Employment

Sources We use two sets of tabulations by size of employment for Switzerland. First, we have tabulations between 1929 and 2008 from the Establishment Census (“Eidgenössische Betriebszählung”).

⁴⁹The entries in the register are based on information published in the Swiss Commercial Gazette.

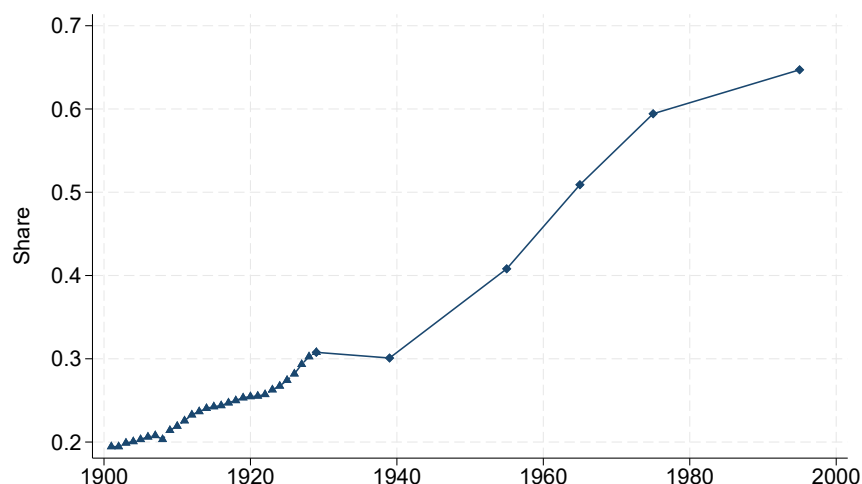


Figure DA11. Switzerland: Corporate Share Estimates

Notes: The figure shows the estimated corporate share for Switzerland. We use the employment share of corporations and LLCs (after their introduction in 1937) after 1929 (solid line with diamonds), and a linear extrapolation based on the proportion of corporations among all registered businesses before then (dashed line with triangles).

We download PDFs from the Swiss statistical office ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1933, 1946, 1965, 1967, 1977](#); [Bundesamt für Statistik, 1994, 1998, 2000, 2002, 2007](#)), and then transcribe the data. In addition, for 1991 to 2008, we also obtain granular tables with additional size groups for the aggregate economy directly from the STATENT Team at the Swiss statistical office ([Bundesamt für Statistik, 2025a](#)). The final edition of the Establishment Census was conducted in 2008, after which it was replaced by the business register Structural Business Statistics (STATENT). Second, we obtain tabulations for 2011 to 2022 directly from the Swiss statistical office, which uses information in STATENT ([Bundesamt für Statistik, 2011-2022](#)). STATENT provides nationwide data on all enterprises in Switzerland, and is based on administrative data from the Swiss social security register and the Swiss business register.

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation in our tabulations is a firm, defined as the smallest legally independent economic unit. Firms can consist of multiple establishments. The census covers establishments above a minimal activity threshold, defined as roughly 400 hours of work per year in the 1955 to 1975 editions and 20 hours per week from 1985 onward ([Eidgenössisches Statistisches Amt, 1977](#); [Bundesamt für Statistik, 1994, 1998](#)). Agriculture is excluded.

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, LLCs, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. The unit of observation is a legally independent entity with decision-making autonomy, such as making strategic choices and paying employees. An economic entity (individual or legal) that pays social security contributions for people earning more than 2,300 Swiss Francs per year is recorded as a productive unit in STATENT ([Bundesamt für Statistik, 2025b](#)). The data cover all

sectors of the economy, and we exclude agriculture to ensure consistency with census data.

Variable definition For the first source, tabulations prior to 1985 include both full-time and part-time workers, and all individuals who work at least six hours per week after 1985 (regardless of pay, including business owners, unpaid family members, and temporary workers); the 1985 tabulation is restricted to full-time workers.

For the second source, employment includes all individuals (both employed and self-employed) earning more than the social security threshold of 2,300 Swiss Francs. This threshold did not change over our sample period.

Sector harmonization The Establishment Census and STATENT include tabulations of firms by sector and employment size. We use these sectoral tabulations to estimate top shares in manufacturing and retail/wholesale trade, which are roughly comparable with SIC codes 20-39 (manufacturing) and 50-59 (retail/wholesale trade). Sectoral classifications were updated over our sample period requiring some adjustments to create sectors that are as consistent as possible over the long run. We make sure that manufacturing always excludes construction, mining, and utilities. Trade typically includes retail, wholesale, and trade brokerage. Automobile repair shops have been classified as part of the trade sector since 1994, whereas before they were considered part of manufacturing. However, they cannot be easily or consistently assigned to either sector.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ employment share = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by size of employment in a given year/All employment in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ employment share among top $y\%$ = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by employment in a given year/Employment of top $y\%$ firms by employment in a given year.
- Top N employment share = Employment of top N firms by size of employment in a given year/All employment in a given year.

DA1.9 U.K.

Table [DA9](#) lists the sources that we use for the U.K.

DA1.9.1 By Net Output and Turnover

Sources Our analysis for the U.K. focuses on manufacturing due to data availability in the early years. First, we have tabulations by size of net output from the Census of Production between 1958 and 1992. We download PDFs from the LSE digital library ([Board of Trade, 1960-1973](#); [Department of Industry Business Statistics Office, 1973-1992](#)), and transcribe the data. In addition, [Prais \(1976\)](#) provides estimates of the share of the 100 largest enterprises in manufacturing by net output for selected years from 1909 to 1968 (see Appendix A of [Prais \(1976\)](#) for details), using historical census data and various other sources such as [Leak and Maizels \(1945\)](#) and [Hart \(1960\)](#). For the top 100 share, we use

Table DA9 – U.K.: Data Sources

Type	Period	Source
Tabulations by net output	1909–1968	Prais (1976) .
	1958–1992	Office for National Statistics (various years) <i>Census of Production</i> .
Tabulations by sales	1985–2022	Office for National Statistics (various years) <i>Size Analysis of United Kingdom Businesses</i> ; from 2004 onwards titled <i>UK Businesses: Activity, Size and Location</i> .
Tabulations by employment	1958–1992	Office for National Statistics (various years) <i>Census of Production</i> .
	1985–2022	Office for National Statistics (various years) <i>Size Analysis of United Kingdom Businesses</i> ; from 2004 onwards titled <i>UK Businesses: Activity, Size and Location</i> .

Notes: This table lists the sources of the U.K. data.

his estimates until 1968 and Census of Production estimates afterward; these two sets of estimates are almost identical when they overlap between 1958 and 1968. Second, we can find tabulations of the number of businesses by size of turnover (sales) since 1985. Between 1985 and 1997, we obtain physical books from Harvard University Library and Stanford University Library, and transcribe the data ([Department of Trade and Industry, Business Statistics Office, 1985–1997](#)); after 1998, we download data in Excel spreadsheets from the Office for National Statistics ([Office for National Statistics, 1998–2003, 2004–2013, 2015–2022a](#)). These data are based on value added tax (VAT) returns submitted to HM Customs and Excise (processed by the Central Statistical Office until 1995, and the Office for National Statistics thereafter).

Scope The data by net output cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation is an enterprise, defined as establishments under common ownership or control. The Census of Production tabulations by net output include private enterprises employing 100 or more persons ([Board of Trade, 1960–1973](#); [Department of Industry Business Statistics Office, 1973–1992](#)). It is reasonable to assume that the largest manufacturers in the numerator have more than 100 employees. We supplement these tabulations with information about the total number of enterprises and total net output in manufacturing from separate summary tables to get the proper denominator. The census data do not include foreign establishments or non-industrial establishments of manufacturing firms.

The data by turnover cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation is a legal unit before 1994 and an enterprise afterwards. The

enterprise is the smallest combination of legal units which has a certain degree of autonomy within an enterprise group. It is generally the same as the legal unit but in some cases enterprises are formed from several legal units with close financial links. The VAT registration has a time-varying minimum turnover threshold, from £18,000 in 1985 to £85,000 in 2022 ([Department of Trade and Industry, Business Statistics Office, 1985-1997](#); [Office for National Statistics, 1998-2003, 2004-2013, 2015-2022a](#)). Enterprises below the VAT registration threshold are excluded before 1992, and are included afterwards if they have chosen to register voluntarily or not to de-register (zero turnover firms are excluded before 2003 and included afterwards if their employment is non-zero).

Variable definition For the census data ([Board of Trade, 1960-1973](#); [Department of Industry Business Statistics Office, 1973-1992](#)), net output is defined as “the value added to materials by the process of production (including the margin on selling any merchanted or factored goods).” It is calculated as gross output – purchases adjusted for change in value of stocks of fuel and raw materials – payments for work given to other establishments – payments for transport – net amount of any duties, subsidies, allowances and levies payable.

For the turnover data ([Department of Trade and Industry, Business Statistics Office, 1985-1997](#); [Office for National Statistics, 1998-2003, 2004-2013, 2015-2022a](#)), they generally exclude VAT but include other taxes, such as the revenue duties on alcoholic drinks and tobacco. The data represent total U.K. turnover, “including exempt and zero-rated supplies” ([Office for National Statistics, 1998-2003](#)), which suggests that exports are included and foreign sales are excluded.

Figure DA12 shows the coverage of the net output and turnover tabulations. The left panel shows log total net output and total turnover from the tabulations. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated net output relative to manufacturing value added (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales relative to manufacturing gross output (dashed line with diamonds). Both ratios are stable around one, which indicates that the coverage of our data is comprehensive and consistent.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ net output share = Net output of top $x\%$ manufacturers by net output in a given year/All manufacturing net output in a given year.
- Top N net output share = Net output of top N manufacturers by net output in a given year/All manufacturing net output in a given year.
- Top $x\%$ sales share = Sales of top $x\%$ manufacturers by sales in a given year/All manufacturing sales in a given year.

For U.K. data by size of sales, the tabulations only show the number of firms in each bin, but not their total sales. In this case, we can still use the generalized Pareto interpolation, but estimates can be less precise. We use the average firm size (for all firms) to provide additional information for the interpolation, which tends to improve the fit. To calculate the average firm size, we obtain

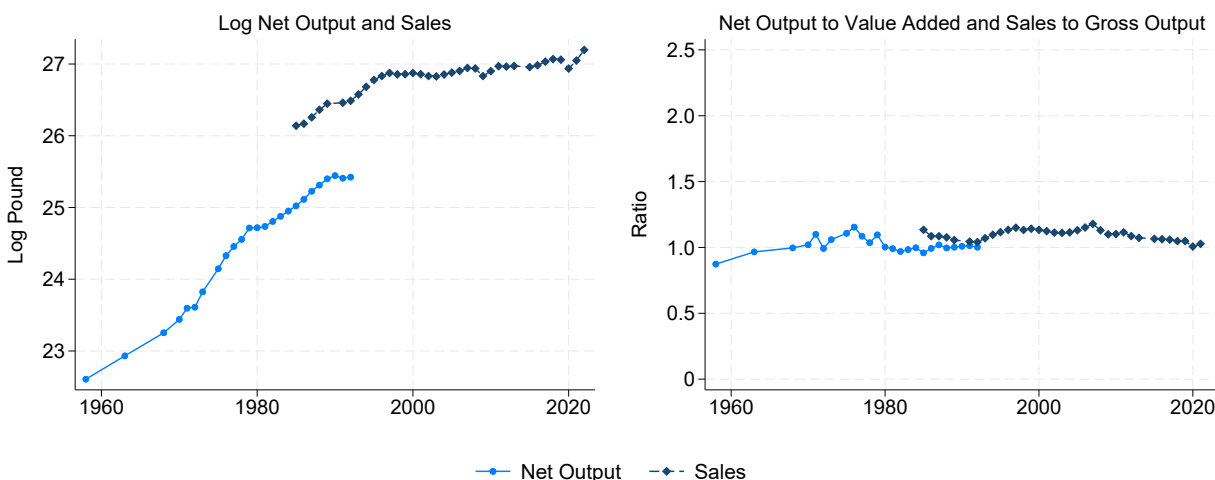


Figure DA12. U.K.: Coverage of Net Output and Turnover Tabulations

Notes: The left panel shows the log of all tabulated net output and turnover in our data. The right panel shows the ratio of tabulated net output relative to manufacturing value added (solid line with circles), and the ratio of tabulated sales relative to manufacturing gross output (dashed line with diamonds). Manufacturing value added data come from [Chadha et al. \(2018\)](#) and [United Nations \(2023a,b\)](#). Manufacturing gross output data come from the United Nations National Accounts Statistics ([United Nations, 2022a,b](#)).

total manufacturing sales from the Census of Production for 1985 to 1993 ([Department of Industry Business Statistics Office, 1985-1993](#)), the Annual Business Inquiry for 1995 to 2007 ([Office for National Statistics, 2010](#)), and the Annual Business Survey (successor of the Annual Business Inquiry) from 2008 to 2022 ([Office for National Statistics, 2025](#)); we linearly interpolate manufacturing sales in 1994.

DA1.9.2 By Employment

Sources Tabulations for manufacturing firms by size of employment come from two sources like the above. The first source is the Census of Production, from 1958 to 1992 ([Board of Trade, 1960-1973](#); [Department of Industry Business Statistics Office, 1973-1992](#)). The second source is the *Size Analyses of United Kingdom Businesses*, from 1985 to 2022 ([Department of Trade and Industry, Business Statistics Office, 1985-1997](#); [Office for National Statistics, 1998-2003, 2004-2013, 2014-2022b](#)). We use the Census of Production data until 1992 and the *Size Analyses of United Kingdom Businesses* from 1993 onwards because the data from the Census of Production are more granular.

Scope For the first source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation is an enterprise, defined as establishments under common ownership or control. The tabulations by employment include private sector enterprises employing one or more persons.⁵⁰

⁵⁰For 1958, the tabulation does not include the counts of firms with fewer than 25 employees. We estimate it by applying the 1963 ratio of establishments to enterprises among firms with fewer than 25 employees to the corresponding 1958 establishment count (establishment counts are relatively stable between 1958 and 1970).

For the second source, the data cover all legal forms, including corporations, partnerships, and sole proprietorships. Each unit of observation is a legal unit before 1994 and an enterprise afterwards. The enterprise is the smallest combination of legal units which has a certain degree of autonomy within an enterprise group. It is generally the same as the legal unit but in some cases enterprises are formed from several legal units with close financial links. The tabulations cover VAT-registered enterprises; the registration threshold and the treatment of enterprises below it are described above in Data Appendix Section [DA1.9.1](#).

Variable definition For the first source, employees include full- and part-time employees and working proprietors.

For the second source, employment includes working owners and all workers paid directly from the business's payrolls, and excludes voluntary workers or agency workers paid directly from the agency payroll.

Data construction

- Top $x\%$ employment share = Employment of top $x\%$ firms by size of employment in a given year/All employment in a given year.
- Top N employment share = Employment of top N firms by size of employment in a given year/All employment in a given year.

DA1.10 Summary

Table DA10 summarizes the sources described above. Each row corresponds to one data source (grouped by size metric), and describes the legal forms covered, the sector, the definition of the size variable, the consolidation basis, and any inclusion threshold.

Table DA10 – Summary of Data by Country and Type

Country	Source (Years)	Legal Forms	Sector	Scope / Definition	Consolidation	Threshold
Panel A. By sales — economy-wide						
Austria	Sales/VAT stats (1954–2020)	All	All [§]	Domestic + exports	Yes	Sales/VAT registration floor
Denmark	VAT stats (1970–1999)	All	All [§]	Domestic + exports	Yes*	VAT registration floor
Denmark	Business register (2000–2020)	All	Non-agricultural	Domestic + exports	Yes**	Active firms only
France	BMS/Insee (1949–1950)	All	BIC [‡]	Domestic + exports	No	
France	S&EF/Insee (1952–1979)	All	BIC [‡]	Domestic + exports	No	
France	Annuaire/SUSE (1981–1997)	All	BIC [‡]	Domestic + exports	No	
Germany	Sales/VAT stats (1926–2019)	All	All [§]	Domestic + exports	Yes (except 1945 to 1958)	Sales/VAT registration floor
Switzerland	Estab. Census (1965)	All	Non-financial, non-agricultural	Domestic + exports	No	
Switzerland	VAT stats (1995–2021)	All	All [§]	Domestic + exports + foreign sales	Yes*	VAT registration floor

Country	Source (Years)	Legal Forms	Sector	Scope / Definition	Consolidation	Threshold
U.S.	IRS SOI (1959–2022)	Corps	All	Domestic + exports	Yes*	
Panel B. By sales — industry-level						
Germany	Sales/VAT stats (1926–2019)	All	Manufacturing, re- tail/wholesale trade, services¶	Domestic + exports	Yes (except 1945 to 1958)	Sales/VAT registration floor
South Korea	Annual reports (1972–1982)	Corps	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	No	Asset floor (≥ 3 billion Won)
South Korea	KIS-VALUE (1982–2011)	Corps	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	No	Asset floor (≥ 3 billion Won)
U.K.	Size Analysis (1985–2022)	All	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	Yes** after 1994	VAT registration floor
U.S.	IRS SOI (1959–2022)	Corps	Manufacturing, re- tail/wholesale trade, services	Domestic + exports	Yes*	
Australia	CR20 mfg census (1968–1991)	All	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	Yes	Single estab. with fewer than 4 per- sons excluded 1974–1987
Germany	CR10 concentration (1954–2021)	All	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	No	≥ 10 workers until 1975, ≥ 20 workers after
Panel C. By net output — manufacturing						
U.K.	Prais (1909–1968)	All	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	Yes	
U.K.	Census of Production (1958–1992)	All	Manufacturing	Domestic + exports	Yes	
Panel D. By net income — economy-wide						
Australia	Taxation Statistics (1940–2020)	Corps	All	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	Yes* after 2002	Positive income
Canada	Taxation Statistics (1944–1964)	Corps	Non-financial	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	No	Positive income; sales floor
Canada	Corp. Taxation Stats (1969–1987)	Corps	Non-financial	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	No	Positive income; asset + sales floor from 1985

Country	Source (Years)	Legal Forms	Sector	Scope / Definition	Consolidation	Threshold
Singapore	Yearbook (1972–2004)	Corps	All	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	No	Positive income
Singapore	IRAS (2005–2022)	Corps	All	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	No	Positive income
U.S.	IRS SOI (1918–1974)	Corps	All	Domestic + certain foreign income of residents	Yes* (except 1934 to 1941)	Positive income
Panel E. By equity capital — economy-wide						
Denmark	Company register (1902–1983)	Corps (+ LLCs from 1974)	All	Paid-in capital	No	Minimum capital floor from 1977
Denmark	KOB/Experian (1989–2018)	Corps + LLCs	All	Book equity	No	Minimum capital floor
Germany	Prussian stat. office (1904–1920)	Corps + LLCs	All	Paid-in capital	No	Minimum capital floor
Germany	Commercial register (1936–1992)	Corps + LLCs	All	Paid-in capital	No	Minimum capital floor
Switzerland	Business register (1901–1985)	Corps (+ LLCs from 1937)	All	Paid-in capital	No	Minimum capital floor from 1937
Panel F. By employment — economy-wide						
France	Fichier (1966)	All	BIC [‡]	Excl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
France	Fiscal declar. (1973, 1975)	All	BIC [‡]	Excl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
France	Annuaire/SUSE (1981–1997)	All	BIC [‡]	Excl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
Germany	Census of Estab. (1925–1987)	All	Non-agricultural	Incl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
Germany	Company register (2003–2018)	All	Non-agricultural	Social security-eligible employees (excl. owners)	No	VAT revenue floor, or has social security-eligible employee
Switzerland	Estab. Census (1929–2008)	All	Non-agricultural	Incl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms; estab. ≥ 400 hours/year (1955–1975) and ≥ 20 hours/week (1985–2008)

Country	Source (Years)	Legal Forms	Sector	Scope / Definition	Consolidation	Threshold
Switzerland	STATENT (2011–2022)	All	Non-agricultural	Social security-eligible persons (incl. owners)	No	Incl. non-employer firms; pays social security contributions
U.S.	SSA (1938–1948)	All	Non-agricultural	Excl. owners	No	Employer firms
U.S.	SCB (1939–1956)	All	Non-agricultural, excl. professional services	Excl. owners except 1939	No	Incl. non-employer firms
U.S.	BDS (1978–2022)	All	Non-agricultural	Excl. owners	Yes	Employer firms
Panel G. By employment — industry-level						
Australia	Enterprise Statistics (1968–1986)	All	Manufacturing	Incl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
Australia	Australian Industry (2004–2005)	All	Manufacturing	Incl. owners	Yes**	Incl. non-employer firms
Germany	Census of Estab. (1925–1987)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Incl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms
Germany	Company register (2003–2018)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Social security-eligible employees (excl. owners)	No	VAT revenue floor, or employer firms (≥ 1 social security-eligible employee)
South Korea	Annual reports (1972–1982)	Corps	Manufacturing		No	Asset floor (≥ 3 billion Won)
South Korea	KIS-VALUE (1982–2011)	Corps	Manufacturing		No	Asset floor (≥ 3 billion Won)
Switzerland	Estab. census (1929–2008)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Incl. owners	No	Incl. non-employer firms; estab. ≥ 400 hours/year (1955–1975) and ≥ 20 hours/week (1985–2008)
Switzerland	STATENT (2011–2022)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Social security-eligible persons (incl. owners)	No	Incl. non-employer firms; pays social security contributions
U.K.	Census of Production (1958–1992)	All	Manufacturing	Incl. owners	Yes	Incl. non-employer firms
U.K.	Size Analysis (1985–2022)	All	Manufacturing	Incl. owners	Yes** after 1994	Incl. non-employer firms; VAT registration floor

Country	Source (Years)	Legal Forms	Sector	Scope / Definition	Consolidation	Threshold
U.S.	SCB (1939–1951)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Excl. owners except 1939	No	Incl. non-employer firms
U.S.	Enterprise Statistics (1958–2012)	All	Manufacturing, retail/wholesale trade	Excl. owners	Yes	Employer firms except 1958

**Consolidation is optional.* Multiple related legal entities may elect to consolidate into one observation via joint filing, but it is not mandatory. Eligible companies generally consolidate in Australia and the U.S.

***Consolidation is partial.* For Australia, the unit is generally a business in the ABS Business Register; the ABS may use a type-of-activity unit for large and complex businesses combining entities within an enterprise group by industry activity. For Denmark, the unit is the smallest combination of legal units forming an organizationally and financially autonomous entity. For the U.K., the unit is the smallest combination of legal units which has a certain degree of autonomy within an enterprise group.

§*VAT-exempt activities.* The Austrian, Danish (1970–1999), German, and Swiss VAT tabulations share the same list of VAT-exempt activities: most banking and insurance services, healthcare, private education, cultural services, and long-term leasing of real estate. Firms with VAT-exempt activities appear in the data if they voluntarily file, or if they are required to file for other reasons (e.g., additional taxable activities, or in Germany imports from another EU country); most of the VAT-exempt sales are included in the tabulations in this case.

‡*France firm types.* The tabulations cover industrial and commercial (Bénéfices Industriels et Commerciaux, or BIC) firms. Non-commercial (Bénéfices Non Commerciaux, or BNC) firms (e.g., self-employed professionals like doctors and lawyers) and agriculture (Bénéfices Agricoles, or BA) firms are taxed under separate regimes and are not included.

¶*Germany sectoral adjustments.* Manufacturing excludes stone/ceramics/glass extraction and processing (sometimes mixed with mining) to obtain a consistent series. Services stop in 2009 to consistently exclude telecommunications; healthcare is excluded before 1968 due to VAT reforms.

DA2 Capital to Labor Ratio Data

This appendix describes the data for the capital to labor ratios in Figures [IA12](#) and [IA13](#). In each country and industry, we measure the capital to labor ratio as the real net stock of fixed capital divided by employment. We express every series in thousands of constant 2017 dollars per worker, converted from local currencies using the Penn World Table price level of the capital stock in 2017 ([Feenstra, Inklaar, and Timmer, 2023](#)).⁵¹ For the economy-wide series we exclude real estate, which is dominated by owner-occupied housing.

Australia (1968–2019) For Australia, we obtain the real net capital stock and employment by industry from OECD STAN ([OECD, 2025](#)). The economy-wide series is available from 1970. For manufacturing and trade, capital begins in the mid-1960s but employment only in 1984. We extend manufacturing back to 1968 using employment from the Australian Bureau of Statistics ([Australian Bureau of Statistics, 1990](#)), chaining its growth onto the OECD STAN level at the 1984 overlap.

Austria (1976–2019) For Austria, we obtain the real net capital stock and persons engaged by industry from EU KLEMS ([Luiss Lab of European Economics, 2023](#)) since 1995. We extend the series to 1976 using the EU KLEMS 2009 release ([Groningen Growth and Development Centre, 2009](#); [O’Mahony and Timmer, 2009](#)).

Canada (1961–2019) For Canada, we obtain the real net capital stock and employment by industry from OECD STAN ([OECD, 2025](#)) for 1970 onward (trade employment from 1997). We extend manufacturing and trade back to 1961 using the Canadian Productivity Accounts ([Statistics Canada, 2025](#)), chaining the growth of the real non-residential net capital stock per hour worked onto the OECD STAN level at the overlap year.

Denmark (1970–2019) For Denmark, we obtain the real net capital stock and persons engaged by industry from EU KLEMS ([Luiss Lab of European Economics, 2023](#)) since 1995. We extend the series to 1970 using the EU KLEMS 2009 release ([Groningen Growth and Development Centre, 2009](#)). The published Danish data for manufacturing have a break at the 2002 national accounts revision due to a change in basis, which we fix by rescaling the level of the earlier years to the post-2002 basis.

France (1978–2019) For France, we obtain the real net capital stock and persons engaged by industry from EU KLEMS ([Luiss Lab of European Economics, 2023](#)) since 1995. France is absent from the 2009 EU KLEMS capital files, so we extend the series to 1978 using OECD STAN ([OECD, 2025](#)), which reports the real net capital stock and employment by industry.

⁵¹First, each country’s chained-volume net capital stock is put on a 2017-price basis by scaling the volume series with the ratio of the 2017 current-cost net stock to the 2017 volume level (reported in the same source), which leaves all growth rates unchanged. Second, we convert 2017 national prices into dollars using the Penn World Table price level of the capital stock in 2017 ([Feenstra, Inklaar, and Timmer, 2023](#)); this conversion step is not needed for the U.S.

Germany (1960–2019) For Germany, we obtain the real net capital stock and persons engaged by industry from EU KLEMS ([Luiss Lab of European Economics, 2023](#)) since 1995; German capital by industry is available only from 1991 (reunification). We extend the series back to 1960 using the West German national accounts ([Statistisches Bundesamt, 1995](#)), which report the net fixed capital stock in constant 1985 prices and employment by industry, chaining the West German growth onto the unified-Germany level at 1991.

South Korea (1970–2019) For South Korea, we obtain the real net capital stock and employment by industry from OECD STAN ([OECD, 2025](#)) for 1970 onward. Trade employment in OECD STAN begins in 1992, and we extend it back to 1980 using employment from the Korea KLEMS database ([Asia KLEMS, 2015](#)), which closely matches OECD STAN for the overlap years.

U.K. (1970–2019) For the U.K., we obtain the real net capital stock and persons engaged by industry from EU KLEMS ([Luiss Lab of European Economics, 2023](#)) since 1995. We extend the series back to 1970 using the EU KLEMS 2009 release ([Groningen Growth and Development Centre, 2009](#)).

U.S. (1947–2019) For the U.S., we obtain the net stock of private fixed assets by industry from the BEA ([U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis, 2025c,b](#)), and divide it by employees on nonfarm payrolls from the Bureau of Labor Statistics ([U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, 2025](#)). The series began in 1947.

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